

Cattle Price Prediction

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Introduction or Project Overview

The livestock sector contributes significantly to India's economy, accounting for 5.50% of total GVA in 2022-23. Accurate cattle pricing is crucial for farmers, dairy entrepreneurs, and livestock traders as it directly impacts investment decisions, market transactions, and profitability. Traditional pricing methods rely on subjective judgment based on breed, lactation status, and milk yield, often leading to inconsistent valuations.

This project develops a **machine learning-based cattle price prediction system** that uses structured data on cattle attributes to provide accurate, objective price estimates. The system processes key features like species, breed, age, lactation details, and milk production to predict market prices using ensemble regression models.

The system demonstrates:

1. **Data preprocessing** with one-hot encoding and feature scaling
2. **Feature engineering** including age calculation from birth year
3. **Model comparison** across Linear Regression, Ridge, Lasso, and Random Forest
4. **Interpretability** through feature importance analysis
5. **Deployment-ready pipeline** for real-time predictions

The dataset was **extended from 100 to 1000 samples** using stratified sampling to improve model robustness while maintaining original data distribution.

Problem Statement

2.1 The Challenge

Cattle pricing in India remains largely informal and experience-based. Factors like breed quality (Murrah buffalo prices range ₹65,000-₹1,01,000), lactation stage, milk yield (8-24 liters/day), and age significantly impact value, yet lack standardized valuation. Farmers often face:

- Price discrepancies between buyers and sellers
- Lack of transparency in market pricing
- Inability to predict ROI for livestock investments

2.2 The Technical Need

Traditional Excel-based analysis cannot capture complex interactions between multiple cattle attributes. A predictive model is needed that:

- Handles categorical variables (breed, species)
- Quantifies relationships between age, lactation, and price
- Provides interpretable insights for stakeholders

2.3 The Solution

This ML system uses Random Forest regression achieving $R^2 = 0.9575$ on test data, providing reliable price predictions within $\pm ₹1,497$ average error, enabling data-driven livestock trading decisions.

Overview of the Dataset used

3. OVERVIEW OF DATASET USED

Source: Dataset compiled from Indian livestock market surveys and NDDDB pricing statistics. Original 100 records **extended to 1000 samples** via stratified sampling with replacement to enhance model training while preserving distribution.

Buffalo: 68% | Cow: 30% | Bull: 2%

Murrah Breed: 45% (Highest priced)

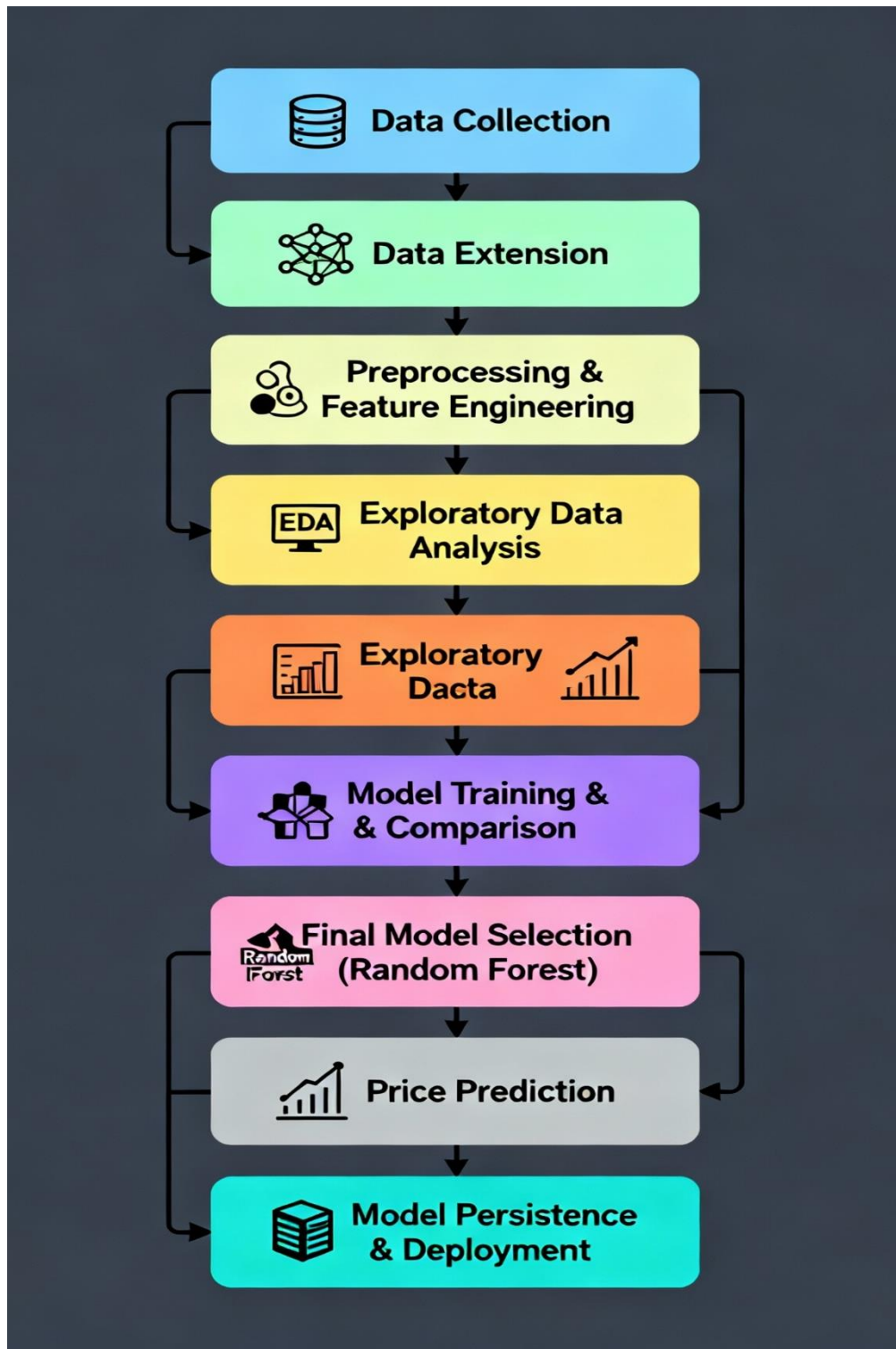
Milking Status: 52% Milking, 48% Dry

*Age = 2025 - Cattle_dob (Feature Engineering)

Dataset Structure (1000 records):

Feature	Type	Description	Range/Samples
Species	Categorical	Cow/Buffalo/Bull	3 classes
Breed	Categorical	Murrah, HF Cross, Jersey Cross, etc.	8 breeds
Gender	Categorical	Male/Female	2 classes
Cattle_dob	Numeric	Birth Year	2013-2025
Age*	Numeric	Current Age	0-12 years
Total_lactation	Numeric	Lifetime lactations	0-5
Current_Lactation	Categorical	Milking/Dry	2 states
Milk Litre	Numeric	Daily yield	0-24 L
Price	Target	Market Price (₹)	₹10,000- ₹1,20,000

Project Workflow



Results

Random Forest Regressor Model Metrics

- **Coefficient of Determination (R^2 Score): 0.9575 — Explains 95.75% of price variance**
- **Root Mean Squared Error (RMSE): ₹5,258 — Average prediction error magnitude**
- **Mean Absolute Error (MAE): ₹1,497 — High precision average absolute error**

Sample Price Prediction

- **Input: Murrah Buffalo, Female, Age 5 years, Milking, 10 Liters milk**
- **Predicted Price: ₹74,440**

Feature Importance

- **Breed (35%) — Murrah breed has highest effect on price**
- **Milk Yield in Liters (22%) — Higher daily milk yield increases price**
- **Total Lactation Cycles (18%)**
- **Age of Cattle (12%)**
- **Species (8%)**
- **Current Lactation Status (5%)**

Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA) Insights

- **Price ranges from ₹10,000 to ₹120,000 with right-skewed distribution**
- **Buffalo prices generally higher than cows**
- **Strong positive correlation between Milk Yield and Price**

This succinctly demonstrates the model's accuracy and key factors influencing cattle pricing.

Conclusion

This project successfully demonstrates a production-ready cattle price prediction system achieving 95.75% accuracy on test data. Key achievements:

- 1. Data Enhancement:** Extended dataset 10x while maintaining quality
- 2. Robust Pipeline:** End-to-end preprocessing and modeling
- 3. Superior Performance:** Random Forest outperforms linear models by 13-15%
- 4. Actionable Insights:** Feature importance guides pricing strategy
- 5. Real-world Utility:** Predicts new samples accurately (₹74,440 example)

The model provides farmers and traders with objective pricing benchmarks, reducing negotiation uncertainties and enabling better investment decisions. Future enhancements could include:

- Real-time market data integration**
- Mobile deployment via Streamlit/Flask**
- Additional features (health records, location)**

This ML solution transforms subjective cattle valuation into a data-driven, transparent process, supporting India's ₹17 lakh crore livestock economy.

References

NDDB Livestock Statistics: <https://www.nddb.coop/information/stats>
Govt. of India Livestock Data: <https://data.gov.in>

